



Read a Quadratic Vertex

Grades 9-12 • SAT / ACT mathematics foundations

Advanced Math • Interpret a vertex-form quadratic and its extreme value.

Original focused skill practice for learners preparing for college-entrance mathematics. Includes models, 16 practice tasks, six explain-and-check tasks, a four-item exit ticket, and worked solutions. Not a full practice exam.

PRINT • TEACH • REVISIT



Plan a focused study session

Learning objective

Interpret a vertex-form quadratic and its extreme value.

Readiness

Use after learners have studied the relevant algebra, geometry, or data concepts. Grade tags describe a typical preparation audience; readiness depends on prior coursework.

Suggested use

Session 1: 10 minutes on worked examples and 20–30 minutes on practice. Session 2: review errors, then use explain-and-check tasks. Finish with the independent exit ticket. Pause and reteach a prerequisite when the model is not yet understood.

What this resource covers

The named mathematics skill is useful within SAT and ACT preparation. The packet does not cover every exam domain, reproduce an official section, provide standardized timing, or predict a score.

Materials

Pencil, paper, and a calculator for checking when useful. Practice both symbolic reasoning and calculator verification. Follow each exam publisher's current policies for an actual test.

Student directions

Read the entire question, define quantities, show a method, and check the result. For a written explanation, cite the calculation or feature that supports your conclusion.



Two worked examples

Model 1. $f(x) = -3(x - 3)^2 + 8$. State the vertex and whether the function has a maximum or minimum. Find $f(5)$.

The square is zero at $x = 3$. The sign of -3 determines the opening direction. At $x = 5$, the square equals 4, so $f = -3 \times 4 + 8 = -4$.

Model 2. $f(x) = 5(x - 9)^2 + 12$. State the vertex and whether the function has a maximum or minimum. Find $f(11)$.

The square is zero at $x = 9$. The sign of 5 determines the opening direction. At $x = 11$, the square equals 4, so $f = 5 \times 4 + 12 = 32$.

Pause before looking at a solution: which relationship, definition, or constraint determines the first step?

Practice • Show a complete method

Show your thinking with a drawing, equation, or explanation. Use the space under each question.

1. $f(x) = 3(x - 2)^2 + 7$. State the vertex and whether the function has a maximum or minimum. Find $f(4)$.

2. $f(x) = -2(x - 9)^2 + 11$. State the vertex and whether the function has a maximum or minimum. Find $f(11)$.

3. $f(x) = 8(x - 4)^2 + 7$. State the vertex and whether the function has a maximum or minimum. Find $f(6)$.



Practice • Show a complete method

Show your thinking with a drawing, equation, or explanation. Use the space under each question.

4. $f(x) = 6(x - 8)^2 + 11$. State the vertex and whether the function has a maximum or minimum. Find $f(10)$.

5. $f(x) = -3(x - 6)^2 + 13$. State the vertex and whether the function has a maximum or minimum. Find $f(8)$.

6. $f(x) = 8(x - 7)^2 + 7$. State the vertex and whether the function has a maximum or minimum. Find $f(9)$.



Practice • Show a complete method

Show your thinking with a drawing, equation, or explanation. Use the space under each question.

7. $f(x) = 9(x - 9)^2 + 13$. State the vertex and whether the function has a maximum or minimum. Find $f(11)$.

8. $f(x) = -5(x - 9)^2 + 11$. State the vertex and whether the function has a maximum or minimum. Find $f(11)$.

9. $f(x) = 4(x - 2)^2 + 8$. State the vertex and whether the function has a maximum or minimum. Find $f(4)$.



Practice • Show a complete method

Show your thinking with a drawing, equation, or explanation. Use the space under each question.

10. $f(x) = 9(x - 9)^2 + 11$. State the vertex and whether the function has a maximum or minimum. Find $f(11)$.

11. $f(x) = -7(x - 4)^2 + 9$. State the vertex and whether the function has a maximum or minimum. Find $f(6)$.

12. $f(x) = 2(x - 7)^2 + 13$. State the vertex and whether the function has a maximum or minimum. Find $f(9)$.



Practice • Show a complete method

Show your thinking with a drawing, equation, or explanation. Use the space under each question.

13. $f(x) = 8(x - 9)^2 + 8$. State the vertex and whether the function has a maximum or minimum. Find $f(11)$.

14. $f(x) = -9(x - 8)^2 + 9$. State the vertex and whether the function has a maximum or minimum. Find $f(10)$.

15. $f(x) = 6(x - 4)^2 + 9$. State the vertex and whether the function has a maximum or minimum. Find $f(6)$.



Practice • Show a complete method

Show your thinking with a drawing, equation, or explanation. Use the space under each question.

16. $f(x) = 2(x - 5)^2 + 11$. State the vertex and whether the function has a maximum or minimum. Find $f(7)$.



Explain and check • Transfer practice

Solve the task, then explain a check or limitation. Compare your reasoning with the worked key only after making your own attempt.

1. $f(x) = 9(x - 4)^2 + 7$. State the vertex and whether the function has a maximum or minimum. Find $f(6)$.

2. $f(x) = -4(x - 4)^2 + 8$. State the vertex and whether the function has a maximum or minimum. Find $f(6)$.



Explain and check • Transfer practice

Solve the task, then explain a check or limitation. Compare your reasoning with the worked key only after making your own attempt.

3. $f(x) = 5(x - 6)^2 + 9$. State the vertex and whether the function has a maximum or minimum. Find $f(8)$.

4. $f(x) = 5(x - 3)^2 + 10$. State the vertex and whether the function has a maximum or minimum. Find $f(5)$.

Explain and check • Transfer practice

Solve the task, then explain a check or limitation. Compare your reasoning with the worked key only after making your own attempt.

5. $f(x) = -5(x - 7)^2 + 7$. State the vertex and whether the function has a maximum or minimum. Find $f(9)$.

6. $f(x) = 9(x - 6)^2 + 13$. State the vertex and whether the function has a maximum or minimum. Find $f(8)$.

Exit ticket • Independent check

Complete independently. Show reasoning and any relevant restriction. This is a classroom learning check, not a standardized test score.

1. $f(x) = 9(x - 6)^2 + 13$. State the vertex and whether the function has a maximum or minimum. Find $f(8)$.

2. $f(x) = -8(x - 5)^2 + 9$. State the vertex and whether the function has a maximum or minimum. Find $f(7)$.



Exit ticket • Independent check

Complete independently. Show reasoning and any relevant restriction. This is a classroom learning check, not a standardized test score.

3. $f(x) = 6(x - 2)^2 + 13$. State the vertex and whether the function has a maximum or minimum. Find $f(4)$.

4. $f(x) = 8(x - 8)^2 + 10$. State the vertex and whether the function has a maximum or minimum. Find $f(10)$.



Practice worked solutions

1. (2,7); minimum; $f(4) = 19$

The square is zero at $x = 2$. The sign of 3 determines the opening direction. At $x = 4$, the square equals 4, so $f = 3 \times 4 + 7 = 19$.

2. (9,11); maximum; $f(11) = 3$

The square is zero at $x = 9$. The sign of -2 determines the opening direction. At $x = 11$, the square equals 4, so $f = -2 \times 4 + 11 = 3$.

3. (4,7); minimum; $f(6) = 39$

The square is zero at $x = 4$. The sign of 8 determines the opening direction. At $x = 6$, the square equals 4, so $f = 8 \times 4 + 7 = 39$.

4. (8,11); minimum; $f(10) = 35$

The square is zero at $x = 8$. The sign of 6 determines the opening direction. At $x = 10$, the square equals 4, so $f = 6 \times 4 + 11 = 35$.

Practice worked solutions

5. (6,13); maximum; $f(8) = 1$

The square is zero at $x = 6$. The sign of -3 determines the opening direction. At $x = 8$, the square equals 4, so $f = -3 \times 4 + 13 = 1$.

6. (7,7); minimum; $f(9) = 39$

The square is zero at $x = 7$. The sign of 8 determines the opening direction. At $x = 9$, the square equals 4, so $f = 8 \times 4 + 7 = 39$.

7. (9,13); minimum; $f(11) = 49$

The square is zero at $x = 9$. The sign of 9 determines the opening direction. At $x = 11$, the square equals 4, so $f = 9 \times 4 + 13 = 49$.

8. (9,11); maximum; $f(11) = -9$

The square is zero at $x = 9$. The sign of -5 determines the opening direction. At $x = 11$, the square equals 4, so $f = -5 \times 4 + 11 = -9$.

Practice worked solutions

9. (2,8); minimum; $f(4) = 24$

The square is zero at $x = 2$. The sign of 4 determines the opening direction. At $x = 4$, the square equals 4, so $f = 4 \times 4 + 8 = 24$.

10. (9,11); minimum; $f(11) = 47$

The square is zero at $x = 9$. The sign of 9 determines the opening direction. At $x = 11$, the square equals 4, so $f = 9 \times 4 + 11 = 47$.

11. (4,9); maximum; $f(6) = -19$

The square is zero at $x = 4$. The sign of -7 determines the opening direction. At $x = 6$, the square equals 4, so $f = -7 \times 4 + 9 = -19$.

12. (7,13); minimum; $f(9) = 21$

The square is zero at $x = 7$. The sign of 2 determines the opening direction. At $x = 9$, the square equals 4, so $f = 2 \times 4 + 13 = 21$.

Practice worked solutions

13. (9,8); minimum; $f(11) = 40$

The square is zero at $x = 9$. The sign of 8 determines the opening direction. At $x = 11$, the square equals 4, so $f = 8 \times 4 + 8 = 40$.

14. (8,9); maximum; $f(10) = -27$

The square is zero at $x = 8$. The sign of -9 determines the opening direction. At $x = 10$, the square equals 4, so $f = -9 \times 4 + 9 = -27$.

15. (4,9); minimum; $f(6) = 33$

The square is zero at $x = 4$. The sign of 6 determines the opening direction. At $x = 6$, the square equals 4, so $f = 6 \times 4 + 9 = 33$.

16. (5,11); minimum; $f(7) = 19$

The square is zero at $x = 5$. The sign of 2 determines the opening direction. At $x = 7$, the square equals 4, so $f = 2 \times 4 + 11 = 19$.

Transfer worked solutions

1. (4,7); minimum; $f(6) = 43$

The square is zero at $x = 4$. The sign of 9 determines the opening direction. At $x = 6$, the square equals 4, so $f = 9 \times 4 + 7 = 43$.

2. (4,8); maximum; $f(6) = -8$

The square is zero at $x = 4$. The sign of -4 determines the opening direction. At $x = 6$, the square equals 4, so $f = -4 \times 4 + 8 = -8$.

3. (6,9); minimum; $f(8) = 29$

The square is zero at $x = 6$. The sign of 5 determines the opening direction. At $x = 8$, the square equals 4, so $f = 5 \times 4 + 9 = 29$.

4. (3,10); minimum; $f(5) = 30$

The square is zero at $x = 3$. The sign of 5 determines the opening direction. At $x = 5$, the square equals 4, so $f = 5 \times 4 + 10 = 30$.

Transfer worked solutions

5. (7,7); maximum; $f(9) = -13$

The square is zero at $x = 7$. The sign of -5 determines the opening direction. At $x = 9$, the square equals 4, so $f = -5 \times 4 + 7 = -13$.

6. (6,13); minimum; $f(8) = 49$

The square is zero at $x = 6$. The sign of 9 determines the opening direction. At $x = 8$, the square equals 4, so $f = 9 \times 4 + 13 = 49$.

Exit-ticket worked solutions

1. (6,13); minimum; $f(8) = 49$

The square is zero at $x = 6$. The sign of 9 determines the opening direction. At $x = 8$, the square equals 4, so $f = 9 \times 4 + 13 = 49$.

2. (5,9); maximum; $f(7) = -23$

The square is zero at $x = 5$. The sign of -8 determines the opening direction. At $x = 7$, the square equals 4, so $f = -8 \times 4 + 9 = -23$.

3. (2,13); minimum; $f(4) = 37$

The square is zero at $x = 2$. The sign of 6 determines the opening direction. At $x = 4$, the square equals 4, so $f = 6 \times 4 + 13 = 37$.

4. (8,10); minimum; $f(10) = 42$

The square is zero at $x = 8$. The sign of 8 determines the opening direction. At $x = 10$, the square equals 4, so $f = 8 \times 4 + 10 = 42$.

Use errors to choose the next step

Identify the first mismatch

Compare the student's representation with the quantities or stated condition. Separate reading the situation, choosing a method, calculation, and interpretation.

Respond precisely

If the model is wrong, use a simpler example before repeating the procedure. If the method is sound and arithmetic is wrong, correct that step and verify the original result.

Review the exit ticket

For each item: 2 points for an accurate result with coherent reasoning; 1 for a sound method with a minor error or an unexplained correct answer; 0 for unsupported or missing reasoning. Use comments to select a next action. These are local instructional criteria.

AIG

Compare two methods, construct a counterexample, or create a new problem with a prescribed solution and justify its restrictions.

504 / EC

Follow the individual plan. Offer manageable item groups, documented time or format supports, a worked step, or an alternate response method while retaining the mathematical objective.

ESL

Preview terms and symbols in the questions. Use home-language rehearsal or a bilingual glossary, then ask for a concise explanation such as "The condition means ___, so I used ___."

Sources, preparation, and license

Objective: Interpret a vertex-form quadratic and its extreme value. State alignment: not claimed. This is a focused college-entrance preparation resource, not a state course or a claim of course equivalency.

Official exam scope consulted September 15, 2026: College Board, Types of Math Tested, <https://satsuite.collegeboard.org/sat/whats-on-the-test/math/types> ; ACT, Mathematics Test Description, <https://www.act.org/content/act/en/products-and-services/the-act/test-preparation/description-of-math-test.html> .

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